

To: The Budget Planning Committee

RE: Most Cost-Efficient Solution for Upgrading the Fleet

In light of ongoing public budget tightening, efficient resource allocation has become a critical priority for municipal decision-makers, and we propose a cost-minimization optimization model that balances financial constraints with service requirements. Detailed decision variables, objective functions and constraints of our approached have been identified as the following.

Decision Variables

X = number of New Type A buses to purchase

Y = number of New Type B buses to purchase

Z = number of New Type C buses to retain

Objective function

Minimize Total Cost = $50,000X + 70,000Y$

Constraints

1. Budget: $50,000X + 70,000Y \leq 10,000,000$
2. Seating Capacity: $25X + 50Y + 50Z \geq 15,000$
3. Drivers: $X + Y + Z \leq 450$
4. Fuel efficiency: $10X + 8Y + 5Z / (X + Y + Z) \geq 6$
Equivalent: $4X + 2Y - Z \geq 0$
5. Non-negative: $X, Y, Z \geq 0$

Our Recommendation

We recommend to purchase (i) 67 Type A buses, (ii) 0 Type B buses and to retain (iii) 266 Type C buses, which achieves the lowest total cost of \$ 3,350,000 after rounding to integers, according to the Excel Solver solution.

PLAN A: Cost-Efficiency				
Bus type	Seating capacity	Fuel efficiency [MPG]	Purchase cost [\$]	
New Type A bus	25.00	10.00	50000.00	
New Type B bus	50.00	8.00	70000.00	
Type C bus	50.00	5.00		
		New Type A buses	New Type B buses	Type C buses
DECISIONS VARIABLES	number of buses	66.67	0.00	266.67
OBJECTIVE FUNCTION	budget	3333333.333		
CONSTRAINTS	Item	Value	UPPER	LOWER
	budget	3333333.333	10,000,000	
	Fuel Efficiency	0		0
	Seating capacity	15000		15000
	drivers	333.3333333	450	